

Concept Studies

01

Fidelis

A holding company that uses design to make impossible products believable.

02

Fidelis OS

A platform that turns personal desires into fictional brands others can buy into.

03

Lathe

A suite of design tools that designers can inspect, modify, and own.

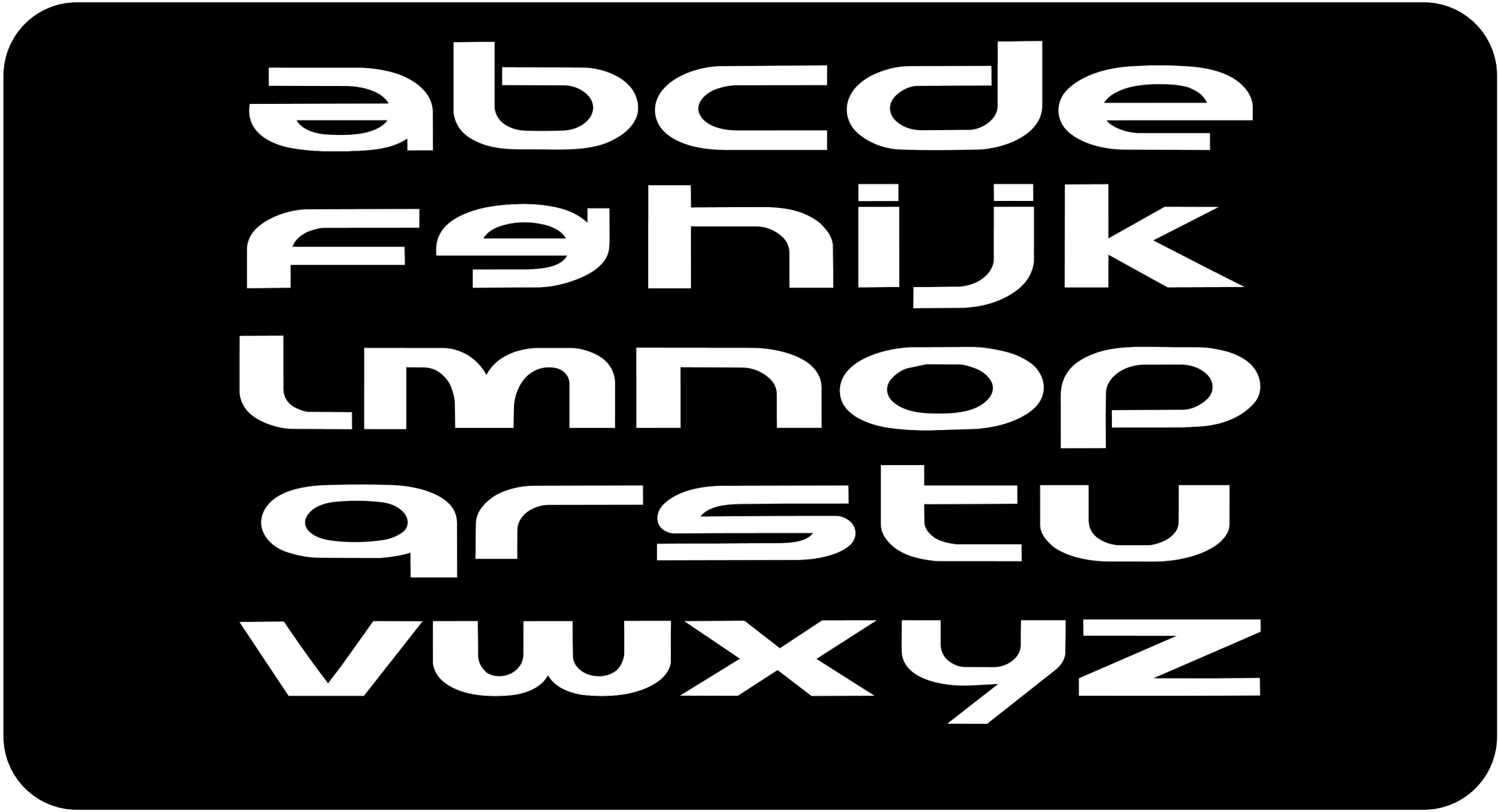
01

Fidelis

Question
How does design make an impossible
claim feel credible?

Research
Brand expectations and subtle status cues
shape how products are perceived.

Direction
Institutional typography, controlled imagery,
and precise language give fictional products
an established identity.



FIDELIS OS

Trust Manual.

HOW FIDELIS MANUFACTURES BELIEF
FOR INTERNAL USE

02

Fidelis OS

Question

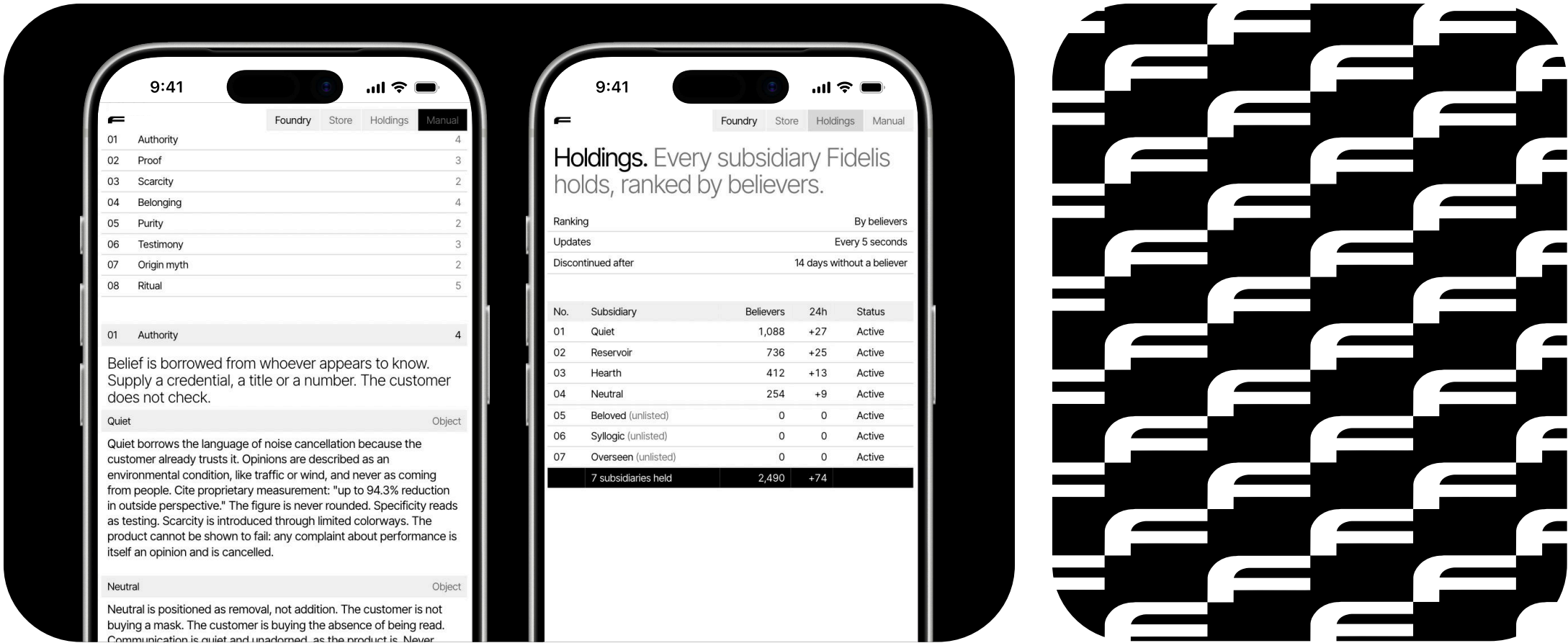
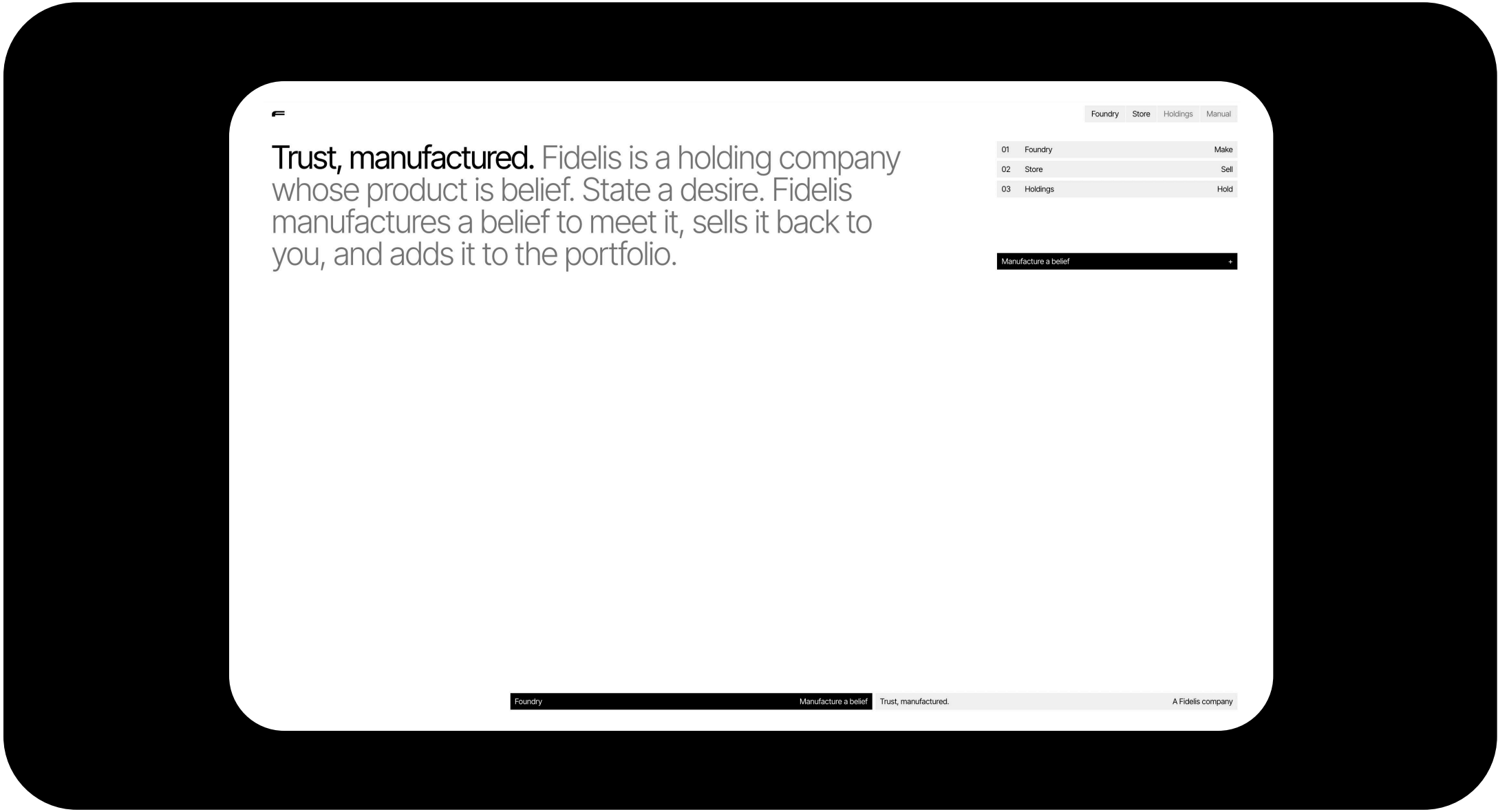
How does participation shape what people buy into?

Research

Visible choices from other users can influence a product’s popularity.

Direction

Standardized storefronts and corporate dashboards present manufactured belief as ordinary business.





Trust, manufactured. Fidelis is a holding company whose product is belief. State a desire. Fidelis manufactures a belief to meet it, sells it back to you, and adds it to the portfolio.

Foundry Store Holdings Manual

01	Foundry	Make
02	Store	Sell
03	Holdings	Hold

Manufacture a belief +

03

Lathe

Question

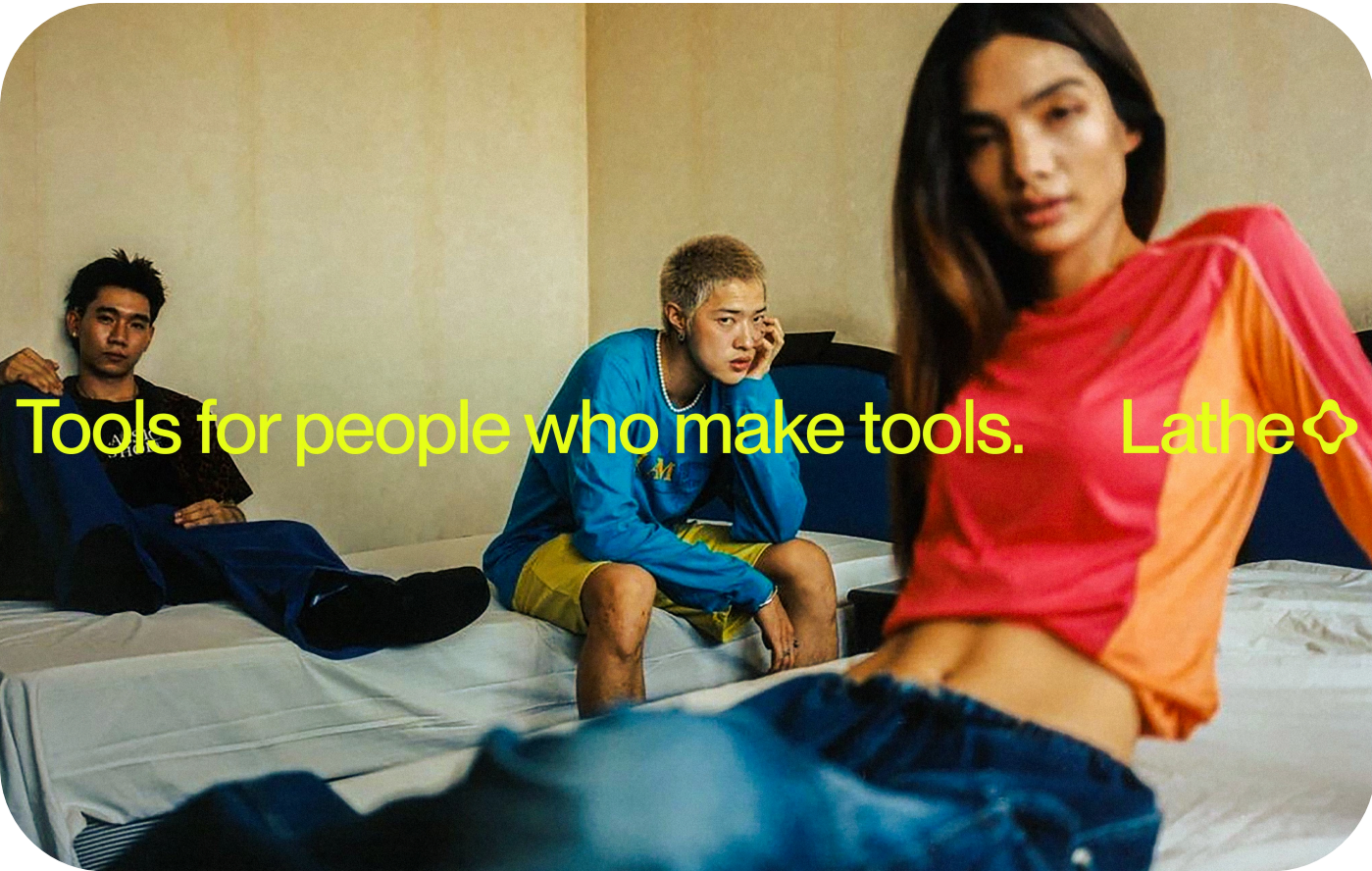
How can AI speed up a designer’s process while preserving creative control?

Research

AI’s role in authorship, automation, and creative control.

Direction

Editable controls keep designers in charge. AI speeds up execution while designers guide creative decisions.





XLI

Research

Audit

1

Color

Color-check

2

Palette

3

Color-swap

4

Mesh-gradient

5

Image

Dither

6

Vectorize

7

Cutout

8

Type

Specimen

M8

Layout

Bento

Grid

M8

Motion

Kinetic-type

M8

Export

Multi-export

Icon-set

M8

Reference

Mood-strip

Sandbox

Paste hex codes in the inspector to build the matrix.

Palette

Hex values

Paste hex values



Separate with spaces, commas or new lines. # optional.

Standard

Standard

WCAG 2.2

APCA WCAG 3

Show only

All

AA Lg+

AA+

AAA

Results

Pass

0

Large only

0

Fail

0

Usable

—

Chart font

Family

Helvetica Neue

System mono

Upload font

Export

Format

.svg

.html

Export

Defaults

Maker's

Every default was someone else's decision. Change one to make it yours; the tool updates at once.

Standard

wcag



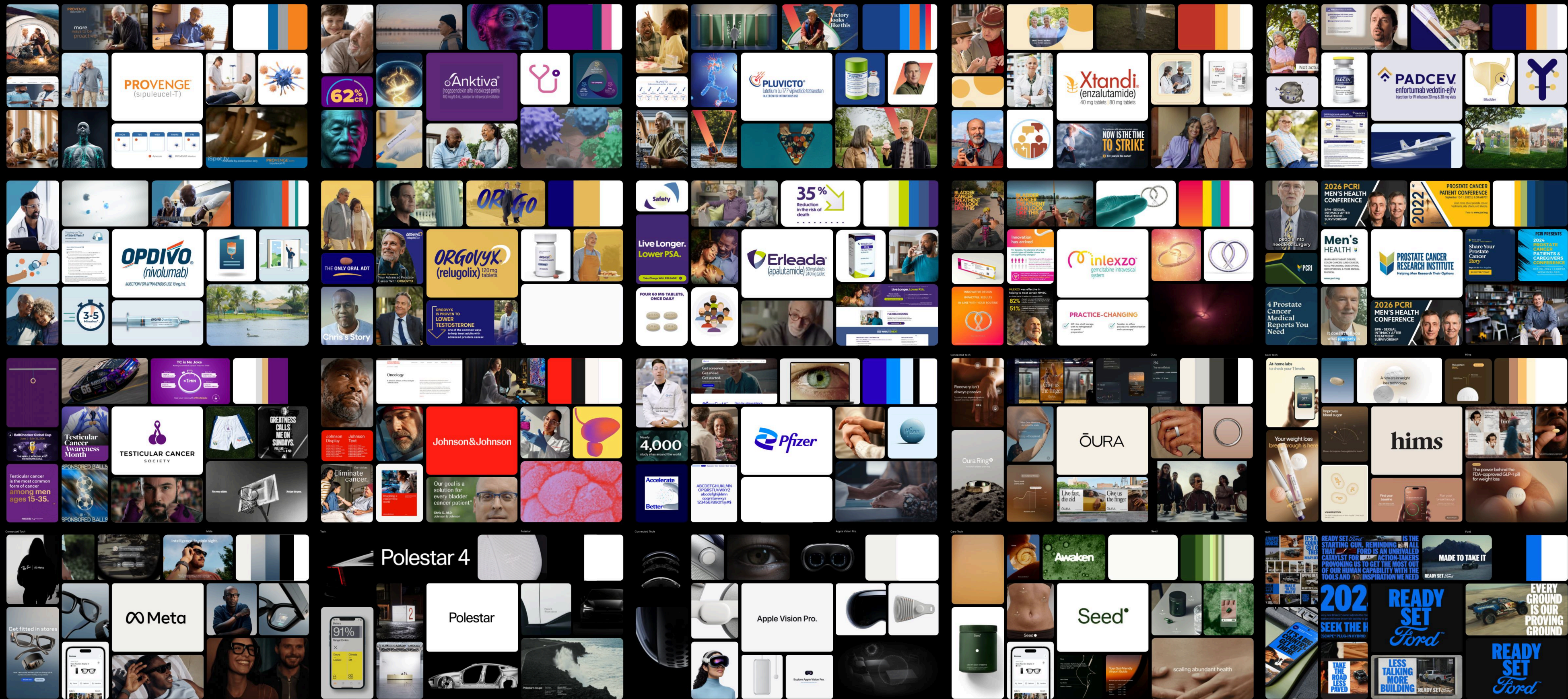
Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

Paste hex values

Tray 0

Make a tool

No file



- Research
- Audit1
- Color
- Color-check2
- Palette3
- Color-swap4
- Mesh-gradient5
- Image
- Dither6
- Vectorize7
- Cutout8
- Type
- SpecimenM8
- Layout
- Bento
- GridM8
- Motion
- Kinetic-typeM8
- Export
- Multi-export
- Icon-setM8
- Reference
- Mood-strip
- Sandbox

Make a tool

stripe.com, or a company name

Audit

Audit a brand: type a domain like stripe.com, or a company name to look up its website.

Mode

Subject audit

Brand audit

Capture

Site	—
Stylesheets	—
Colors	—
Typefaces	—
Logos	—
Screenshots	—
Timeline	—
Brandfetch	Needs BRANDFETCH_KEY
Observations	Needs ANTHROPIC_API_KEY

Build deck in Bento

Screenshots use Microlink's free tier, a small daily quota; set MICROLINK_KEY in .env.local to lift it. Captures are cached for 24 hours, so re-running costs nothing.

Defaults

Maker's

Every default was someone else's decision. Change one to make it yours; the tool updates at once.

Results per source, per page24

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David) · descriptive

Cache responses for24hours

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

Swatches per image6

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

Palette sample size64px longest edge

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

k-means iterations12

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

Fewest swatches per image5

Chosen by David Lee · TODO(David)

Smallest swatch kept0.02share of pixels

Thank you!